

Language Study

Grammar/Comp
Dictation
Composition
Commonplace





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Grammar/Comp: Grade 9, Dictation: Grade 9, Composition: Grade 9, Commonplace: Grades 9-12

About Grammar/Comp: Grade 9

This course works alongside Michael Clay Thompson's Essay Voyage lessons. It invites students to explore writing concepts such as tone, style, point of view, and more. Students also experiment with multiple written forms and gain familiarity with key habits of academic writing.

About Dictation: Grade 9

Students use passages from their books to practice dictation skills.

About Commonplace: Grades 9-12

Building on the habit of copywork in younger grades, high school students copy passages of any length that strike them from their readings into their commonplace book. For some students this becomes a lifelong keepsake and continuing habit.



Placement & Combining Tips

Grammar/Comp: Grade 9

New students entering Grade 9 without much former Grammar instruction should complete MCT's Grammar and Practice Voyage scheduled in Grade 8. Composition prompts often reference Alveary lessons in Literature, History, Geography, Bible, etc., so it is ideal if students are using Alveary subjects across the curriculum. However, lessons include the lesson topic and target skill/form, along with ideas for substitution when possible to make the lessons flexible for teachers and students.

Dictation: Grade 9

Depending on the student, dictation may or may not be necessary at this level.

Commonplace: Grades 9-12

Students new to copywork or keeping a commonplace book may want to schedule this during morning lessons to build the habit.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9	Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 2 times/week 20 min 2 times/week 30 min	Essay Voyage Essay Voyage Teacher Manual (select pages)
9	Dictation: Grade 9 1+ time/week 20 min	
9-12	Commonplace: Grades 9-12 1+ time/week 10 min	

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Language Study: Grade 9				
Grammar/Comp: Grade 9	Grammar/Comp: Grade 9	Dictation: Grade 9 Commonplace: Grades 9-12	Grammar/Comp: Grade 9	Grammar/Comp: Grade 9



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Grammar/Comp: Grade 9

☐ Bookmark or print the documents listed in Quick Links below for use throughout the term.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Language Study: Grade 9

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Essay Voyage



Essay Voyage Teacher Manual (select pages)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Language Study: Grade 9

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Foundations \(See Sections 3 & 8: Narration & English\)](#)

Grammar/Comp: Grade 9

∞ [Essay Voyage Answer Key](#)

∞ [Narration Ideas Document](#)

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or scan the QR
code for links.



Language Study: Grade 9

How To Approach



Read

Read your books for the week in your various subjects, including Essay Voyage.



Narrate

Narrate after you read and copy down any interesting quotes into your commonplace book!



Practice

You will practice many forms of composition over the year. Your books will often serve as the foundation for your assignments.



Prepare

DICTATION: For one lesson a week, you will prepare to write from dictation a paragraph or more from your readings by visualizing new words and paying close attention to punctuation.



Teacher Note

- As you review your students' composition assignments, be sure to read the instructions in the lesson and give feedback and support accordingly.
- Some students naturally integrate and incorporate ideas from grammar and composition lessons into their narrations and composition assignments, but most assignments ask students to focus on one skill or idea.
- For editing or revision lessons, hold the student accountable to work through the process and instructions given for editing, but refrain from suggesting too many ideas about how they could expand the essay or add another idea.
- For assignments that ask a student to focus on a particular concept, ignore spelling or grammar edits, and support your student by noticing what they've done well and drawing out ideas on how to dig deeper.

Language Study: Grade 9

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WEEK 1 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 1

Correctness

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ INTRO

This book will help you grow your writing skills in all areas. It is especially aimed at helping you learn how to write formal academic essays.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.1-4

→ PRACTICE

1. Why is the grammar of vocabulary words important to think about?
2. Write a short sentence using superfluous as an adjective and another using superfluity as a noun.
3. Write a short sentence using adhere or adhered as a verb and another using adherent as a noun or adhering as an adjective.
4. Write two sentences that use at least one form of each word. For example, I have never been an adherent of expending superfluous energy.

★ STUDENT NOTE

In this book, the word essay refers to a formal academic essay.

In your other composition lessons, we use the term essay to refer to a short piece of writing on a particular topic. This is the primary dictionary definition of the word. Different types of essays in different settings require different ways of writing.

Hopefully, this will prevent any confusion about the use of the word essay in your lessons.

WEEK 1 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 2

Correctness

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.5

→ PRACTICE

Complete the four-level analysis on p.6. Remember to come up with some interesting points about the sentence in the comment section. The comments in the Answer Key are only a guide or possibilities of what you might have noticed.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.7

→ PRACTICE

What do the comma rules do for a sentence? Complete the exercise on p.8 and check your answers.

★ STUDENT NOTE

∞ PDF Link: Essay Voyage Answer Key

WEEK 1 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 1

→ NOTE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

→ PREPARE

Study 2-3 pages of a passage from the week's reading. There should only be around 5-7 unfamiliar words to you in the passage you are studying. For some books, you might need to study more than 2-3 pages to find that many words you don't know. For other books, you will need to study much less. Maybe even less than a page might contain 6 words that are unfamiliar to you. Adjust the amount accordingly.

Then, write the words on a whiteboard or a piece of paper. Work to see each word with your eyes shut. You might need to say the letters aloud, write them in the air, and practice writing them until you have the words memorized.

Notice if the word has familiar parts that can help you remember it. For example, con-junc-tion. Or words with similar patterns that you do know,



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such as Marian and librarian.

Take about 10-15 minutes. Also, notice the punctuation in the passage. Tell your teacher when you are ready to have a paragraph dictated to you.

→ DICTATE

The teacher dictates one paragraph, phrase by phrase, from the passage. Afterward, go over what you wrote and correct any mistakes.

If you have been doing this for several years, you will have built up a habit of paying attention to words when you read. This will help you remember lots of words and how to spell them. If you are new to dictation, you will begin to notice that you are paying more attention to words when you take 15-20 minutes to practice dictation each week.

WEEK 1 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 3 *Asking Questions*

→ INTRO

As in nature study, where we ask ourselves questions to help us observe, so too when we read, we want to ask questions of ourselves to help us observe what is in the text. As we practice noticing and wondering about our books, we will see more to ponder and enjoy.

→ WRITE

Ask yourself questions about one of your readings and write your answers. Here are a few questions to get you started:

- What am I noticing?
- What am I wondering about?
- What does this remind me of?
- What are my initial reactions?
- Why does the author say this?
- How does this relate to other things I have read?
- Why do I think the author wrote in this way?

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

In addition to these more formal composition lessons, be sure to keep up the habit of written and oral narrations throughout the week. Aim for 8-10 written narrations per week, and use different ways of narrating to keep it interesting!

You may write or type your narrations and compositions initially. But for these composition lessons, be sure to type the final draft that you turn in to your teacher.

WEEK 1 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 4 *Tech/Visual*

→ DESIGN

Over the year, you'll create your own reference book for the various poetic forms you study in Poetry Study: Grades 9-12. The purpose is for you to have a quick guide that makes sense to you and is easy to pull up or keep on hand as you read individual poems. Start by creating your own "At a Glance" for the Villanelle. Here are a few of the possibilities:

- Copy the "Villanelle At a Glance" into a designated space in a notebook or a document on a device where you can easily find and reference it in the future. Add any additional notes for yourself that you'd like.
- Draw an illustration or create an infographic in Canva (or similar design software) showing the form more visually.
- Make a PowerPoint and create your own Villanelle at a glance for the first slide (using text and/or visuals).
- Something else! Get creative!

• REFERENCE

Poetry Study: Grades 9-12 (Lesson 1)

Book: Making of a Poem

Language Study: Grade 9

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WEEK 2 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 5

Correctness

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.9 and check your answers.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.10-11 slowly and thoughtfully

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.12 and check your answer. How are the two bad paragraphs disorganized?

WEEK 2 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 6

Correctness

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.14-17

WEEK 2 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 2

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 2 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 7

Poetry

→ WRITE

Start writing your own villanelle. Refer to your at-a-glance guide and villanelles you have read as needed.

• REFERENCE

Poetry Study: Grades 9-12 (Lesson 3)

Book: Making of a Poem

WEEK 2 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 8

Point of View

→ READ & NARRATE

∞ Article Link: What is Point of View in Writing?

→ EVALUATE

Gather the books you are reading in History, and any others you want to evaluate. What point of view are they written from? If you have extra time today, try rewriting one paragraph from a different point of view.

• STUDENT TIP

Consider getting a free Grammarly account, as it will be helpful as you begin to edit and revise your writing over the next several years. (Try to understand why they suggest a certain edit and avoid blindly accepting suggestions. Even grammar software can be wrong sometimes.)

WEEK 3 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 9

Correctness

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.18-20

→ DISCUSS

Does the essay on p.19 follow the model on p.15?

→ PRACTICE

Choose one of the options 1-4 on p.21 to complete. If you choose #3, you

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may need to complete it in the afternoon or if you have extra time left after your next Grammar lesson. If you finish your paragraph and there is still time left, complete #5.

WEEK 3 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 10

Structure

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.23-25

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.25.

WEEK 3 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 3

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 3 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 11

Point of View

→ WRITE

Frankenstein begins with a series of letters written by Robert Walton to his sister. Choose one interesting passage from the letters and rewrite it from a 3rd person point of view (POV).

• REFERENCE

General Lit (Lesson 1-2)

Book: Frankenstein

WEEK 3 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 12

Point of View

→ WRITE

Compose a journal entry or a letter home about a building you've studied in Architecture as if you had visited in person. (Remember, this is called a 1st person POV.)

OR

Write a letter that is at least two paragraphs to persuade your peers to be thoughtful and considerate, avoiding injuring the bodies and souls of others. (Remember, this is called a 1st person POV.)

• REFERENCE

Architecture: Grades 9-12

OR

Ethics: Part 3 (Lesson 3)

Book: Ourselves

WEEK 4 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 13

Structure

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.26-27

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.28 and check your answers. The word expatriate means living outside your native country.

WEEK 4 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 14

Structure

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.29

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercises on p.30-31 and check your answers.

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→ DISCUSS What do punctuation and grammar mistakes do to your experience of reading?	
WEEK 4 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 4 → DICTATE Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.	
WEEK 4 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 15 <i>Research/Essay</i> → WRITE Pick a controversial event, law, or situation you've read about recently in Current Events and research it. Summarize the perspective of each side in your own words. Try to write in such a way that each side would agree with how you have described their perspective. Why do people believe the way they do on both sides? You will have another lesson to add your thoughts on which perspective is best. Today, focus on understanding the different perspectives and some of the reasons for them, and then articulating them in your own words.	• REFERENCE Current Events Resource: Variety of News Sites
WEEK 4 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 16 <i>Poetry</i> → WRITE Start writing your own sestina. Refer to your at-a-glance guide and sestinas you have read as needed. Because sestinas are fairly long and the form is complicated, you may not be able to finish your poem during the allotted time. Try to write at least two stanzas during the lesson and finish the poem on your own time if you like.	• REFERENCE Poetry Study: Grades 9-12 (Lesson 7) Book: Making of a Poem
WEEK 5 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 17 <i>Structure</i> Materials: Essay Voyage → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Essay Voyage p.33-35 Go slowly over the reading; linger over the organization within each paragraph. → PRACTICE Complete the exercise on p.39 and check your answer.	
WEEK 5 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 18 <i>Structure</i> Materials: Essay Voyage → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Essay Voyage p.36-39 → DISCUSS Essays are single-minded; they focus relentlessly on one thing: the thesis. → PRACTICE Summarize in one careful sentence what Emerson says on p.39.	

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WEEK 5 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 5

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 5 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 19

Scene Writing

→ INTRO

Look at a Shakespeare play or another play that you have read and note the punctuation and formatting for writing a scene.

→ WRITE

Write a scene for a play based on Frankenstein or The Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass/Up From Slavery, or another book of your choice. The beginning might be the easiest section to use, but feel free to choose any section you like. You may want to use some of the actual dialogue in the book in your scene!

Bonus Idea: give directions for any special effects (like music) that you would want as part of your scene.

• REFERENCE

General Literature: Grades 9-10 (Term 1)

Book: Frankenstein or The Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

WEEK 5 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 20

Essay

→ WRITE

In Lesson 7, you wrote about a controversial current event. This week, give your opinion on who has the stronger arguments and explain why you think so. Add your thoughts to your document from last week.

• REFERENCE

Current Events

Resource: Variety of News Sites

WEEK 6 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 21

Structure

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.40-41

→ DISCUSS

What does the conclusion accomplish on p.41?

→ PRACTICE

Choose from Options 1-4 on p.43. If you still have time, complete Option #5.

WEEK 6 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 22

Unity

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.45-47

→ DISCUSS

On p.47, connecting words are bolded text, and the microlanguage is circled or has a rectangle around it. Explain how they work together to unify the essay.

WEEK 6 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 6

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for

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dictation.

WEEK 6 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 23

Senses

→ INTRO

Writers add many details about what their characters are sensing to help us enter into the story. Good descriptions immerse us in the sights, sounds, feel, tastes, and smells of a situation.

→ WRITE

Take 15 minutes and think back over yesterday or your morning, and write down descriptive words and phrases for what you have seen, tasted, heard, felt, and smelled. For example, think about the color of the light in your room or outside, the texture and taste of your food, the feel of your chair, bed, or couch, your feet on the floor, the temperature, or your pencil, pen, or keyboard, the colors and shapes around you, and the smells inside and out.

Then take your descriptive words and phrases and write a full paragraph or two describing your day or morning.

• STUDENT TIP

As you read this week, pay attention to the sensory details authors include. What kinds of details can you find in your books? Mostly sight descriptions? Smells, sounds, tastes?

WEEK 6 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 24

Editing

→ REVISE

Pull up your Current Events assignment from Lessons 7 and 10. You'll spend increasingly more time on the editing and revision stages of writing over the next several years. Today, work through the following steps to edit your work:

1. Read it aloud.
2. Add additional thoughts and ideas to your paper.
3. Fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear and see.
4. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to fix any additional errors.
5. Are your paragraphs indented?
6. Is each paragraph focused on one idea?

WEEK 7 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 25

Unity

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.48-51

→ DISCUSS

Which of the classic examples of the vocabulary words on p.48-49 did you find most interesting?

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercises on p.49 and p.52 and check your answers.

WEEK 7 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 26

Unity

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.53

→ PRACTICE

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Complete the exercises on p.54-55 and check your answers.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.57-59

→ DISCUSS

How did Lincoln use personal pronouns to unify his speech and to organize the ideas in the speech? Underline all the we's and us's and put a square around the they's and their's.

WEEK 7 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 7

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 7 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 27

Compare & Contrast

→ WRITE

Compare and contrast what you read in Percy Bysshe Shelley's Defence of Poetry to Wordsworth and Coleridge's Preface to the Lyrical Ballads.

OR

Write two paragraphs comparing children's lives in ancient Rome to children's lives today.

OR

Compare and contrast the similarities and differences between candour and prejudice.

• REFERENCE

History of Lit: Grades 9-12 (Term 1 readings)

OR

Ancient History: Grades 7-9 (Lesson 5)

Book: The Story of Ancient Rome

OR

Ethics: Part 3 (Lesson 5)

Book: Ourselves

WEEK 7 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 28

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on writing assignments that you haven't had a chance to finish in this course.

WEEK 8 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 29

Unity

 Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.60-61

→ PRACTICE

Write a short, five-paragraph essay unified by one word.

WEEK 8 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 30

Unity

 Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.62-65

→ PRACTICE

Choose from Options 1-4 and 6-7 on p.67. Feel free to work on your writing whenever you have the time, but the next Grammar & Composition lesson is dedicated to time for you to write.

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WEEK 8 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 8

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 8 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 31

Questions

→ REFLECT

Explore an idea from your lessons that you'd like to think about more. If nothing comes to mind immediately, start by asking yourself questions about your readings (remember Lesson 1?) in Architecture, Bible, History, Citizenship, or Geography, and something else you'd like to write about.

Here are some of the questions you could ask yourself:

- What am I noticing?
- What am I wondering about?
- What does this remind me of?
- What are my initial reactions?
- Why does the author say this?
- How does this relate to other things I have read?
- Why do I think the author wrote in this way?

→ WRITE

Write multiple paragraphs on something that has interested you.

WEEK 8 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 32

Descriptive Paragraph

→ WRITE

Write a few descriptive paragraphs about the Ancient Rome OR the life of an ancient Roman you have learned about so far this term.

• REFERENCE

Ancient History: Grades 7-9
(Lessons 1-7)

Book: The Story of Ancient Rome

WEEK 9 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 33

Unity

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Work on your writing for the option you chose on p.67. If you have time remaining, complete Option #5.

WEEK 9 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 34

Formality

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.69-73

→ DISCUSS

What are the differences you notice in the two paragraphs on p.73?

WEEK 9 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 9

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

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WEEK 9 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 35

Plot

→ INTRO

How do authors keep you interested in a story or movie? Name as many ways as you can think of.

→ REFLECT

Reread the opening letter of Ch.7 in Frankenstein. How does Victor's father relate what has happened? What questions or expectations does this raise in you, the reader?

And what is the effect of having much of the plot be told through letters?

→ READ & WRITE

Read the article on suspense and look for ways authors hold your interest and move their story forward as you continue reading Frankenstein and your other books!

∞ Article Link: Building Suspense

• REFERENCE

General Literature (Lesson 17)
Frankenstein

WEEK 9 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 36

Character sketch or Expository essay

→ WRITE

Write a character sketch of one of the characters in Frankenstein.

OR

Describe what getting an education meant for either Frederick Douglass or Booker T. Washington, and explain how they persevered to learn to read and write.

• REFERENCE

General Literature: Grades 9-10

WEEK 10 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 37

Formality

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.74-77

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.75 and check your answers.

WEEK 10 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 38

Formality

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.78.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.79

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercises on pp.80-81 and check your answers.

WEEK 10 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 10

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

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WEEK 10 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 39

Dialogue

→ INTRO

Have you ever thought about the differences between how we speak and how we write? Flip through your church history book, "Renewal", and notice when people are speaking. Notice the paragraph indents, punctuation, and the way the author introduces or guides you through the conversation. As one author suggests, when writing dialogue, "Keep your words and sentences short. Break up the speeches with the other person's questions, gestures, or thoughts. Start a new paragraph whenever the next person speaks, does something, or thinks. Short bursts of speech seem natural to the reader. Just as long speech paragraphs seem unnatural, so do long speech sentences. and so do long words" (from Writing Magic by Gail Levine).

→ WRITE

Make up two characters (or pick two characters from the same or different books) and write a conversation including dialogue between the two of them. Here are some options:

- Have several of the Greek scientists discuss some of their new ideas with each other.
- Have Rabindranath Tagore talk to Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda.
- Two English Romantic poets.
- Write a story with dialogue of someone who found themselves in trouble due to their habit of exaggeration.
- Write dialogue between Frankenstein's creature and another character he has not yet met in the novel.

Save a few minutes at the end of the lesson and read your composition aloud. Does the dialogue sound natural?

• REFERENCE

Examples given from Ancient History, General Literature, Poetry Reading, and Ethics: Part 3 (Lesson 10).

WEEK 10 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 40

Personification

Look back through the poems you have read this year to find some examples of personification. An author uses personification when s/he gives an inanimate object or abstract idea the qualities of a person. For instance, here is one of Franklin's aphorisms:
With the remaining time, try writing a few sentences with personification of your own. See what the most outlandish comparison you can make!

WEEK 11 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 41

Formality

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Use this time to finish your essay lessons or your writing assignments from the term, if needed.

WEEK 11 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 42

Formality

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Use this time to finish your essay lessons or other writing assignments from the term, if needed.

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WEEK 11 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 11

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 11 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 43

Poetry Or Illustration

→ WRITE

Write a narrative poem OR create a graphic novel telling the story of an episode Frankenstein.

Bonus Idea: If you write a poem, try including an epic simile!

• REFERENCE

General Literature: Grades 9-10

Book: Frankenstein

WEEK 11 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 44

Editing

→ REVISE

Pick a previous narration or composition assignment that is at least two paragraphs long to edit. Choose a narration from a week or two ago from a book you think is interesting.

1. If you wrote it by hand, make sure to type it up now.
2. Read it aloud.
3. Add additional thoughts and ideas to your paper.
4. Fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear and see.
5. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to fix any additional errors.
6. Are your paragraphs indented?
7. Is each paragraph focused on one idea?

Share your revised narration with someone.

WEEK 12 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 45

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer exam question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Essay Voyage

WEEK 12 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 46

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer exam question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Essay Voyage

WEEK 12 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

There are no exams for this course.

WEEK 12 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 47

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Language Study: Grade 9

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Term 1

WEEK 12  **30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 48**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to course.

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Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 49

Formality

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.83-87

→ PRACTICE

Complete the Exercise on p.85

→ DISCUSS

What does a formal style communicate to the reader? How would the world have received the Declaration of Independence if it had been written in informal English?

WEEK 1 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 50

Formality

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.88-89

→ DISCUSS

Boswell's connecting words

WEEK 1 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 13

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 1 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 51

Reflection

→ REFLECT

What questions do you have about writing? Where do you think you have improved? Where do you think you need to grow? What about writing is the most fun, most confusing, easiest, and hardest?

→ DISCUSS

Discuss your answers with your teacher.

WEEK 1 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 52

Beginnings

→ INTRO

Authors use a variety of ways to get you interested in their book. They might start in the middle of the action, draw you in with a question, immerse you in the setting, introduce you to a character, or something else.

→ ACTIVITY

Grab 5 of your favorite books off the shelf. Read the first paragraph or page of each. How do the authors start each book? What makes you want to keep reading?

→ WRITE

Think of an exciting experience in your own life. Make a list of several possible beginnings for how you could tell the story. What kinds of beginnings capture your attention?

• STUDENT TIP

As you begin new books for school or on your own time, notice how they begin.



Term 2

WEEK 2 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 53

Formality

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.90-92

Notice how the quotes are blended into the text on p.91.

→ NOTE

The Sahara Desert is larger than the continental United States.

→ PRACTICE

Choose from Options 1-4 or 6. You will have your next Grammar & Composition lesson to work on it as well. If interested, complete Option 5 at another time.

WEEK 2 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 54

Formality

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Work on your writing from Lesson 27.

→ VIEW

If you didn't choose option #4, you can't miss looking at some of Gaudi's buildings!

∞ Video Link: Gaudi Architecture

WEEK 2 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 14

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 2 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 55

Questions/ Essay topics

→ REFLECT

Pick a book or topic you've read about recently. Write 5 questions or topics related to your readings that have piqued your curiosity. Feel free to look back at your book while you think and write. One side effect of this type of reflective thinking is that it is an effective way to generate ideas for essays or other writing assignments.

Here are some of the questions you could ask yourself:

- What am I noticing?
- What sensory details does the author include?
- How is the author building the narrative and keeping my attention?
- What am I wondering about?
- What does this remind me of?
- What are my initial reactions?
- Why does the author say ___?
- How does ___ relate to other things I have read?
- Why did the author choose to write from this point of view? How would the book be different if it were written from a different POV?
- What do I want to know more about?

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WEEK 2 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 56

Beginnings Practice

→ WRITE

You will experiment more with different beginnings today. Choose a story from your own life or something you've read to write or rewrite, and compose at least three different beginnings. You don't have to write the whole story. Focus on the beginning of each.

For example, think about The Story of the Three Little Pigs. Instead of starting when the pigs set off to build their houses, what if you started the story when the pig in the stick house had to flee or when the wolf is coming down the chimney into the brick or stone house? How would the altered beginning affect the story?

• STUDENT TIP

If you get stuck choosing a story, just use the story of the Three Little Pigs or another similar tale!

WEEK 3 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 57

Wordiness

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.95-99

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.99 and check your answers.

WEEK 3 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 58

Wordiness

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.100-102

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.102 and check your answers.

WEEK 3 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 15

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 3 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 59

Identifying & Imitating Style

→ INTRO

Have you ever seen or done an impression of someone else? It's often funny to watch people's impressions of famous actors, politicians, or family members because we all have mannerisms that are unique to us and/or our families. We might talk with our hands, overuse a particular exclamation, or consistently have a certain tone (excited, gloomy, etc.!). Have you ever thought about the fact that authors have mannerisms, too? The mannerism or "style" of an author is often something you unconsciously pick up on, but is also something you can consciously notice or consider. Some noticeable aspects of an author's tone and style are due to their historical time period, and some are their own personal flair. Think about Shakespeare's style of writing. If someone read you some lines from a play you hadn't read yet, you might still be able to guess it was written by Shakespeare because you recognized his style.

An author's style, like personal mannerisms, is created by many things such as an author's choice of words, sentence structure and length, the

• STUDENT TIP

As you read throughout the week, try to notice authors' style, and feel free to incorporate anything you notice into your regular narrations (oral or written). What is it about an author's writing that lets you know they are from a particular time, place, or culture? Do they repeat certain words or types of words often? How would you describe their tone?



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amount and type of descriptive words they use, or even the tone of their work. Their tone or "voice" might be cheerful and carefree, ominous and sad, formal, chatty, excited, etc.

→ WRITE

For the rest of this lesson, pretend you are one of your favorite authors and try writing in that author's style. Write a paragraph or two about something you are reading, something in your day, or make something up. If you find it difficult to pick an author to imitate, use Shakespeare or try writing as if you were someone else you know in real life (maybe your best friend, a parent, a public speaker, etc.).

Read your work aloud to someone (who would be familiar with the author you're imitating), and see if they can guess who you're trying to imitate.

WEEK 3 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 60

Showing & Telling

→ INTRO

Describe the difference between these two sentences:

Sentence 1: "Bobby was excited!"

Sentence 2: "Bobby smiled widely, clapped his hands, and let out a joyful whoop!"

Both sentences help you understand that Bobby is excited about something. The first sentence simply tells you this directly. The second shows you Bobby's excitement by giving you details to vividly see Bobby's excitement in your mind's eye.

Authors use descriptive language and details to show what is happening and invite readers to imagine the setting, characters, and action in a story. When an author does a lot of "showing," the action slows down, there may be dialogue, and the characters' thoughts, feelings, and sensations are clearly described. When an author mostly "tells," a lot may happen in only a few paragraphs. Authors use a combination of showing and telling to keep the story moving and to keep your interest. If authors only focus on "telling," you might not get interested in a character or be able to visualize the action of a story. If the book is all "showing," you might lose interest because the pace is so slow.

→ INSPECT

Gather a few literature books off your shelves and inspect a few pages of each to see if you can find examples of telling and showing.

→ WRITE

Write a scene based on your own experience (riding your bike, making a cake, raking leaves, etc.), something you're reading, or something you make up. Think about the details you're including and try to "show" rather than "tell." Try to write a whole page before you finish writing about all the details in your scene. Have fun!

• STUDENT TIP

Keep an eye out for examples of showing and telling in your readings!

WEEK 4 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 61

Wordiness

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.103

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercises on p.104-105 and check your answers.



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WEEK 4 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 62

Wordiness

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.107-111

→ NOTE

Pay close attention to the different placement of periods with short and long quotations on p.110-111.

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.109 and check your answers.

WEEK 4 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 16

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 4 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 63

Compare & Contrast

→ WRITE

Pick two or three different aspects to compare and contrast in a few of these different worlds: Roman World, British North America, Indigenous North America, 19th-century Europe, or Civil War-era America.

Start by brainstorming or making lists about similarities and differences. Once you have a number of points, write a thesis statement summarizing your main points and argument. You could extend this into a full essay during another composition lesson or catch-up day.

WEEK 4 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 64

PowerPoint/Google Slides

→ INTRO

A few times this year, you will have a chance to experiment with different ways to use technology with your writing. Today, you'll work on a presentation with PowerPoint or Google Slides. If you are unfamiliar with PowerPoint or Google Slides, you can google how to use it. However, often the best way to learn something is to simply dive in and learn as you go.

→ CREATE

Many people often use visual aids such as a PowerPoint to accompany a presentation. Slides don't include everything a speaker wants to say, just the key points to help an audience track and pay attention. Keep this in mind as you create a brief presentation (4-6 slides is fine!) about one of these options:

- Three favorite things you've learned so far this year (and why they're your favorite)
- Why [Book] is your favorite
- How a science lab you did worked/the process of the lab and the results
- Introduce 3 significant historical characters or events all happening at the same time in the world

You don't have to follow any specific guidelines for your PowerPoint. The purpose of this assignment is for you to explore a different medium for words and organizing your thoughts.

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→ PRESENT

Plan a time to talk through your presentation with a live audience.

WEEK 5 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 65

Wordiness

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.112-116

→ NOTE

The full capitalization of words (p.113) was a style used for emphasis in the eighteenth century. Also, focus on how periods and commas are used with quotation marks on p.115.

WEEK 5 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 66

Wordiness

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Choose from Options 1-3 or 6 on p.117. If interested, complete Options 4-5 at another time. You will also have an open slot in your Composition lessons (Lesson 72) next week to work on this assignment.

WEEK 5 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 17

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 5 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 67

Point of View

→ WRITE

Frankenstein is written from several characters' perspectives, but they are all 1st person POV. Retell Ch.XVII or another section from a different character's perspective. Then, retell the same selection from a 3rd person (outside) POV. Here are examples to get you started:

1st Person POV (Frankenstein's perspective): "I looked at the creature."

1st Person POV (The creature's perspective): "Frankenstein looked at me."

3rd person POV (Narrator's perspective): "Frankenstein looked at the creature."

• REFERENCE

General Literature: Grades 9-10 (Lesson 31)

Book: Frankenstein

WEEK 5 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 68

Essay

→ WORK ON THE ESSAY YOU STARTED IN LESSON 63.

OR

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on writing assignments that you haven't had a chance to finish in this course.

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WEEK 6 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 69

Content

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.119-123

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.123 and check your answers.

WEEK 6 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 70

Content

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.124-126

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.126 and check your answers.

WEEK 6 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 18

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 6 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 71

Genre Analysis

→ READ & WRITE

Dating back to Aristotle, many authors and playwrights visualize the shape of a story or play in five parts. Read about this 5-part structure, then think (and look) back over what you've read in *The Tempest* in Term 1. Did the play follow this general arc? Where would you identify the introduction, rising action, and climax? Explain.

∞ Article Link: Five-Act Structure

∞ Article Link: Five-Act Opt. 2

• REFERENCE

Plays/Shakespeare (Term 1)
The Tempest

WEEK 6 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 72

Essay Voyage

→ WRITE

Work on your writing assignment from last week in the Grammar & Composition lesson (Lesson 66) from *Essay Voyage* p.117.

• REFERENCE

Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 (Lesson 34)
Book: *Essay Voyage*

WEEK 7 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 73

Content

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.127

→ NOTE

Remember that every sentence has at least one clause.

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercises on p.128-129 and check your answers.

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Term 2

WEEK 7 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 74

Content

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.131-132

→ NOTE

Notice the power of brevity and the absence of a pointless word in Lincoln's letter.

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.132.

WEEK 7 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 19

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 7 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 75

Poetry writing

→ WRITE

Try writing a poem about one of your readings (or rewrite a narration) in Short Meter (four-line stanzas with a 6-6-8-6 syllable pattern). This is a common meter for hymns, and a favorite one of Emily Dickinson (See "A Bird came down the Walk").

• REFERENCE

History of Literature (Lesson 17)
Emily Dickinson

WEEK 7 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 76

Scene writing/dialogue

→ WRITE

Write a scene for a play from Frankenstein, Silas Marner, a History book, a Bible passage, or another reading. Don't forget the instructions for the stage setup and any props! Feel free to look back at a Shakespeare play to remind yourself how to format/write a scene.

• REFERENCE

Term 2 Readings

WEEK 8 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 77

Content

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.134-137

→ NOTE

The fact that a reader is forced to try because the writing is demanding does not mean that the writing is bad. Complicated matters, expressed perfectly, are still complicated.

WEEK 8 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 78

Content

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.138-139

→ DISCUSS

Looking at the essay on p.139, consider if the reader learns from every sentence. Is there a wasted sentence in this essay?

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	→ PRACTICE Choose from Options 1-4 or 6. You will have another lesson this week to work on this assignment (Lesson 80)	
WEEK 8	20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 20 → DICTATE Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.	
WEEK 8	30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 79 <i>Poetry</i> → WRITE Write a narration (or pick a previous narration to rewrite) in blank verse. Or practice writing an epic simile.	
WEEK 8	30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 80 <i>Essay Voyage</i> → WRITE Work on your writing assignment from Grammar/Composition (Lesson 78) this week.	• REFERENCE Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 (Lesson 40) Book: Essay Voyage
WEEK 9	20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 81 <i>Quotation</i> Materials: Essay Voyage → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Essay Voyage p.143-147	
WEEK 9	20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 82 <i>Quotation</i> Materials: Essay Voyage → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Essay Voyage p.148-151 → NOTE Most great prose writers also write poetry, and they use the methods in their prose, too. → PRACTICE Complete the exercise on p.149 and check your answers.	
WEEK 9	20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 21 → DICTATE Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.	
WEEK 9	30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 83 <i>Tracing Character</i> → WRITE How has Victor Frankenstein changed throughout Frankenstein? Look back at your book and see if you can identify a few concrete examples showing how he has changed in his actions and/or thoughts. What was he	• REFERENCE General Lit: Grades 9-10 Frankenstein

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like at the beginning of the book? What is he like now? Then write up your findings. Be sure to make the first sentence of each paragraph your topic sentence and give supporting details in the others.

WEEK 9 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 84

Compare/Contrast

→ WRITE

Write a well-organized paragraph or two comparing The Aeneid's opening Invocation to the Muse (lines 1-13) to the openings of The Iliad and The Odyssey.

∞ PDF Link: Iliad Opening Lines

∞ PDF Link: Odyssey Opening Lines

- How is Virgil both imitating Homer and also doing something very new?

• REFERENCE

Poetry Reading 9-12 (Lesson 37)

WEEK 10 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 85

Quotation

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.152 and check your answers.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.153

→ NOTE

Putting a question mark inside quotes means that the question mark was really IN the quote.

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercises on p.154-155 and check your answers.

WEEK 10 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 86

Quotation

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.157-161

→ NOTE

Some of Franklin's spellings (extremely) are different from our standards. Also, fewer is for things that can be counted: fewer eggs, less sugar. Be sure you go over p.160 carefully and understand what parenthetical citations are.

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.158 and check your answer.

WEEK 10 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 22

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 10 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 87

Editing Prose

→ REVISE

Choose any of your assignment from Lesson 63, 67, 71, or 75 to edit today. Writers often let their work sit for a bit after initially writing their thoughts



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because it's easier to look at your writing as a reader would when the ideas are not as fresh in your head.

1. Make sure you are working in a typed version of your assignment.
2. Read it aloud.
3. Add additional thoughts and ideas to your paper.
4. Fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear and see.
5. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to fix any additional errors.
6. Are your paragraphs indented?
7. Is each paragraph focused on one idea?
8. Give your work a title!

Share your revised narration with someone.

WEEK 10 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 88 *Editing Poetry*

→ REVISE

Pick a poem you've written this term (or you can pick one from last term) to revise. Revising poetry requires a different process than editing other types of writing. There are so few words in a poem (compared to a whole book or essay) that it makes each word even more important.

1. Type your poem if you haven't already.
2. Revisit the rules of your poem's form (sonnet, sestina, ballad, etc.)
3. Read it aloud.
4. Does your poem follow the rules of its form? (Rhyme, meter, line count, etc.) If you are breaking any of the rules, decide if you are breaking them for a reason, to make a point, or if you need to find a different word or phrase to fit the rhyme scheme or meter. (Note: if you choose to break a rule, add a note about why this is important for your poem.)
5. Think about the flow of the ideas and images in your poem. Is there a better way to organize them?
6. Imagery and metaphor are important in nearly all poems. What images and comparisons does your poem use, and are there any others that might capture the image or idea even better?
7. Read your poem aloud again and look for any grammar or spelling errors to fix. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to assist you.
8. Jot down a few of the things you want your reader to walk away thinking or feeling after hearing your poem. Go read your poem aloud to someone (or two!) and ask them what their initial impressions are. If they are completely different than what you intended, consider what you might want to alter so that your purpose comes through more clearly.

• STUDENT TIP

If you aren't comfortable reading your poem aloud to someone, consider just giving them a printed version of your poem. Let them read it and then either tell you or give you a few impressions they've jotted down.

WEEK 11 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 89 *Quotation*

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.162-166

→ NOTE

Pay close attention to the correct demonstration of quotations and parenthetical notes on p.165.

→ PRACTICE

Trace the ship's travels on p.164 on the map on p.166.

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WEEK 11 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 90

Quotation

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Choose from Options 1-4 on p.167. For Option 2, you may also write about the current situation in Sevastopol. For whatever option you choose, only write 1-2 paragraphs; no quotes are required. For Option 4, you may use the internet and not a book for your writing unless you have a book on this topic.

WEEK 11 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 23

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 11 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 91

Reporting

→ WRITE

Create a news paper article letting the Roman people know about Zenobia. Add anything from her story that you'd think would be of great interest to the Roman populace.

• REFERENCE

Ancient History: Grade 7-9
(Lesson 21-22)

Book: A Short History of Ancient Rome

WEEK 11 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 92

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on writing assignments that you haven't had a chance to finish in this course.

WEEK 12 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 93

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer exam question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Essay Voyage

WEEK 12 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 94

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer exam question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Essay Voyage

WEEK 12 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

There are no exams for this course.

WEEK 12 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 95

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

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Answer question(s) related to the course.	
WEEK 12 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 96 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course.	

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Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 97

Conclusion

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.169-173

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.173 and check your answers.

WEEK 1 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 98

Conclusion

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.174-175

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.176 and check your answers.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.177

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.178 and check your answers.

WEEK 1 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 25

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 1 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 99

Essay-Compare/Contrast

→ WRITE

Pick one or two specific passages or verses from your Bible reading in the gospels. Look up the same passage in at least three different translations of the Bible. Then write an essay comparing and contrasting the different translations. Explain the different imagery and how the emphases come out differently. Biblegateway.com is a good online resource to use to compare translations if you do not have three different physical translations in your house.

• REFERENCE

New Testament

Book: NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, any other translations you like!

WEEK 1 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 100

Setting

→ INTRO

Have you ever found yourself so absorbed in a book, you lost track of time? Sometimes authors build such a complete word-world that we are transported! Even in non-fiction books, authors work hard to choose just the right details to orient readers to the time, place, person, or situation they are describing.

→ WRITE

Write all about the setting of one of your readings from the week, or make up a setting for a story. Describe the location with plenty of sensory details (taste, touch, sight, smell, sounds) so that someone else can visualize it too.

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Term 3

WEEK 2 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 101

Conclusion

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.179 and check your answers.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.181

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.182 and check your answers.

WEEK 2 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 102

Conclusion

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.184-189

WEEK 2 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 26

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 2 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 103

Scene Writing

→ WRITE

Write a section from Silas Marner, The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County, The Gift of the Magi, The Aeneid (or another book of your choice) as a short play.

Here is one example of how someone else turned part of Pride & Prejudice into a play. Only read if you're ok with spoilers though!
∞ PDF Link: Scenes by Pertwee

• REFERENCE

General Lit (Term 3 readings)

Poetry Reading (Term 3)

Book: The Aeneid

WEEK 2 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 104

Technology/visual

→ INTRO

There are many ways to see words and stories with colors, shapes, and pictures in addition to just reading words on a page (think of picture books!). Depending on the topic, one way of communicating might be better than another. A birthday party invitation looks much better on a colorful poster than written as a paragraph. On the flip side, paragraphs are essential to a longer book or story.

→ CREATE

Make a poster, infographic, a mind map, or any other sort of visual from your reading that you'd like to see another way. Use one of the ideas below or come up with your own. Draw or model it in 3-D by hand if desired first, and if there is time left, try creating it with technology such as Canva.

- Key events in a historical figure's life
- Key characters in the Aeneid
- Something from Science

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- History of Rome
- Structure of an Epistle in the Bible
- Something from History or Geography

WEEK 3 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 105

Conclusion

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.190-192

→ DISCUSS

Where is the conclusion to this paper? Is it the last paragraph, or could it be this whole page?

WEEK 3 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 106

Conclusion

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Essay Voyage p.193

Choose one of Options 1-4 or 5 to write on. Use this lesson time and Composition Lesson 54 to work on it.

If interested, complete Option 5 at another time.

WEEK 3 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 27

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 3 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 107

Voice/Tone

→ INSPECT

Gather a couple of books, a newspaper, a magazine, and an advertisement. Read a short bit of each and pay attention to the voice or tone of the writing. Watch a short clip of some favorite movies or TV shows. Think about conversations in the grocery or hardware store, a restaurant, a podcast, and in your own home. What are the different tones you are hearing? Are you noticing any differences or similarities among your samples?

→ WRITE

Pick two of these topics or choose two of your own:

- a pet
- a sunrise
- a song
- bird
- a baseball game
- a beach

Describe both your topics in three (or more!) ways:

- with long sentences and long words
- with short sentences and short words
- use a lot of question marks
- use a lot of exclamation marks
- write your description for a young child to understand

• STUDENT TIP

Observe the tone of conversations and the tone in books you are reading. What kinds of tones tend to appear where?

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-write for someone who appeared from another time and place but can understand English

Enjoy exploring the different tones you can create!

WEEK 3 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 108

Essay Voyage

→ WRITE

Work on your writing from your Grammar & Composition lesson this week (Lesson 106)

• REFERENCE

Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 (Lesson 106)

Book: Essay Voyage

WEEK 4 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 109

Meaning

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.195-199

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.199 and check your answers.

WEEK 4 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 110

Meaning

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.200-201

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.202 and check your answers.

WEEK 4 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 28

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 4 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 111

Outline

→ WRITE

Outline a couple of the chapters you have read so far in your Bible History lessons, Ourselves, Geography lessons, reading in A Little Book for New Historians, or something else! (An outline is just a list of the key points from each chapter. It is often done in a bullet-point format.)

WEEK 4 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 112

Description

→ WRITE

Don't forget the importance of details! Write about something you've experienced or read. Pay attention to the details you include. Would someone reading your description have a sense for the setting? Do you include sensory details (all five senses) that immerse them in the experience?

Bonus: after you write your initial paragraph, try writing another paragraph describing the same thing in the style of an author you are reading this term.

• REFERENCE

General Lit: Grades 9-10 (Term 3 readings)

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WEEK 5 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 113

Meaning

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.203

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercises on p.204-205

WEEK 5 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 114

Meaning

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.207-211

→ NOTE

A paragraph can only be about one thing. A new idea means a new paragraph.

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.208 and check your answer.

WEEK 5 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 29

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 5 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 115

Essay - Characterization

→ WRITE

Do you think Aeneas is in charge of his own actions, or is he being controlled by fate and the gods? Give reasons from your reading and cite line numbers.

• REFERENCE

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 (Lesson 64)

Book: The Aeneid

WEEK 5 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 116

POV - 1st Person Interview

→ WRITE

Imagine you are a journalist, interviewing Miss Mason about the importance of self-ordering for young people. What questions might you ask? What answers might she give?

• REFERENCE

Ethics: Part 3 (Lesson 29)

Book: Ourselves

WEEK 6 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 117

Meaning

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.212-213

→ PRACTICE

Write a paragraph or two describing your response to the address if you were a Northern industrialist, a Southern plantation owner, a Southern free Black furniture maker, a Southern enslaved Black, a Chinese Immigrant working on the railroad, a pioneer woman, or a teenager living in a tenement house in New York City.



Term 3

WEEK 6 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 118

Meaning

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.214-216

→ NOTE

A Quay, pronounced KEY, is a dock, a platform for loading a ship.

→ NOTE

Here we see on p.215 an extended introduction that builds a sense of meaning.

→ PRACTICE

Choose from Options 1-6 on p.217. Use the remaining time in the lesson and the next Grammar & Composition lesson to work on your essay.

WEEK 6 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 30

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 6 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 119

Edit/Revising Narrations

→ REVISE

Choose a narration or a composition assignment (at least two paragraphs long) to edit and revise today.

1. Make sure you are working in a typed version of your work.
2. Read it aloud.
3. Add additional thoughts and ideas. Ask yourself what a reader who was only somewhat familiar with your topic might want to know in addition to what you have already written.
4. Fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear and see.
5. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to fix any additional errors.
6. Are your paragraphs indented?
7. Is each paragraph focused on one idea? One way to figure it out is to summarize your paragraph in one sentence.
8. Read your work aloud again and think about your tone. For this assignment, try to make your tone friendly and formal.

Share your revised narration with someone.

WEEK 6 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 120

Editing a Scene

→ REVISE

Revise your scenes from Lesson 103.

1. Spend a few minutes adding any additional details, dialogue, or scenes to your play.
2. Read your play aloud to check punctuation, grammar, and spelling.
3. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to fix any additional errors.
4. Read your dialogue aloud and revise. Does it sound natural? (We tend to speak in short sentences and sentence fragments.)
5. Add instructions for props or setting as desired.

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6. Be sure to include the setting for each scene (i.e., the front yard of a house, a boat, etc.).
7. Make a plan to have some friends perform your play!

WEEK 7 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 121

Finish

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.219-223

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.223 and check your answers.

WEEK 7 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 122

Finish

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.224-225

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercise on p.226 and check your answers.

WEEK 7 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 31

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 7 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 123

Analytical/Descriptive/Poetry

→ WRITE

Pick a commonplace book quote, put the quote into your own words, and then describe why you like it, what other ideas it reminds you of, and where the quote occurs in the context of the book.

OR

Tell about a piece of art from picture study or a piece of music from composer study and describe it in as much detail as you can.

OR

Tell of the importance of glorifying God with your thoughts. You may write this composition as a poem.

• REFERENCE

Composer and Picture Study
OR

Ethics: Part 3 (Lesson 31)

Book: Ourselves

WEEK 7 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 124

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on writing assignments that you haven't had a chance to finish in this course.

WEEK 8 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 125

Finish

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Essay Voyage p.227

→ PRACTICE

Complete the exercises on p.228-229 and check your answers.

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	→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS: Essay Voyage p.231-232. Check your answers.	
WEEK 8	20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 126 <i>Finish</i> Materials: Essay Voyage → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Essay Voyage p.234-237	
WEEK 8	20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 32 → DICTATE Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.	
WEEK 8	30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 127 <i>Essay - Characterization</i> → WRITE Do you think Aeneas changes after his journey to the Underworld? Give reasons from your reading and cite line numbers. OR Write your answer to Miss Mason's question from p.205 of <i>Ourselves</i>, "What sort of person is of use to the world?" Tell what things you can do to become that sort of person.	• REFERENCE Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 Book: <i>The Aeneid</i> OR Ethics: Part 3 (Lesson 32) Book: <i>Ourselves</i>
WEEK 8	30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 128 <i>POV - 1st Person</i> → WRITE Pretend you are Eppie and write a diary entry describing the your plans for the future. OR Imagine you are Godfrey Cass and write a diary entry defending your choice to keep your secret.	• REFERENCE General Literature: Grades 9-10 (Term 3) Book: <i>Silas Marner</i>
WEEK 9	20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 129 <i>Finish</i> Materials: Essay Voyage → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Essay Voyage p.238-242 → DISCUSS Do you see all the parts of a formal essay here?	
WEEK 9	20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 130 <i>Finish</i> Materials: Essay Voyage → PRACTICE Choose from Options 1-5 on p.243 and use this lesson and as many of the remaining Grammar & Composition lessons as you need to write.	
WEEK 9	20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 33 → DICTATE Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.	

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WEEK 9 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 131

Essay - Understanding Perspectives

→ WRITE

Current Event: Pick a topic and research. Summarize the perspective of each side in your own words, including brief quotes from each perspective to support your summary. Hyperlink any articles you reference, as in a news article. Aim to give the best points from each perspective, and imagine talking to a person who believed in each. Would they agree that you understand their perspective and have summarized it well?

Here is a sample outline of how your essay might end up, though you are free to use a different structure as long as you include each of the components. Work on the middle two paragraphs today. You will have three lesson periods to work on this essay.

- 1 short paragraph introducing the topic you're going to talk about and why you think it's important
- 1 paragraph explaining one point of view and the reasons for it
- 1 paragraph explaining the opposite point of view and the reasons
- 1 paragraph explaining which perspective you find most convincing and why

• REFERENCE

Current Events

★ STUDENT/TEACHER TIP

The purpose of this essay is to work on researching the conversation about a particular topic, articulating both sides well in your own words, and giving your thoughts. Try to choose a topic that interests you and will be relatively simple to research. For instance, a topic like whether a particular town should add a train line is a better topic for this assignment than something large and complicated to research, such as whether to vote republican, democrat, or third party.

WEEK 9 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 132

Essay - Opinion

→ WRITE

Add to your current events project from last lesson. Today, develop your opinion on who has the stronger argument and explain why.

Here is a sample outline of how your essay might end up. Work on the first and last paragraphs today.

- 1 short paragraph introducing the topic you're going to talk about and why you think it's important
- 1 paragraph explaining one point of view and the reasons
- 1 paragraph explaining the opposite point of view and the reasons
- 1 paragraph explaining which perspective you find most convincing and why

• REFERENCE

Current Events

WEEK 10 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 133

Punctuation and Usage

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Work on your writing.

→ NOTE

Utilize the Punctuation Rules and Usage Help on p.245-252 when proofreading your work.

WEEK 10 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 134

Punctuation and Usage

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Work on your writing.



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WEEK 10 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 34

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 10 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 135

Editing & Revision: Current Events Project

→ REVISE

Big-Picture Revision

1. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your current events essay? Do that now.
2. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence (i.e., topic sentence) of your paragraph.

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Did you link to the articles you drew from to learn about different perspectives?
2. Read your paper aloud and fix any grammar errors you hear and see.
3. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
4. Give your essay a title. (Think of it like an article about a news event!)
5. Look for wordiness. Are there any unnecessary words? Do you have any sentences that are very long that you could make into two shorter sentences? Long sentences have their place, but usually, shorter sentences are clearer.
6. Make sure your sentences are complete, not fragments.
7. Make sure your essay is consistently in 3rd person while reporting others' perspectives. If desired, you may switch to 1st person when talking about your opinions in the final paragraph(s).

WEEK 10 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 136

Revision - 1st Person POV Description

→ REVISE

Today, you'll revise your diary entry from Lesson 128.

Big-Picture Revision

1. Read your diary entry aloud.
2. Where did you begin the story? Brainstorm at least two other places you could have Eppie or Godfrey Cass begin the story. Choose the one you like best and rework the beginning if necessary.
3. Once you've revised your beginning, consider the flow of the rest of your narrative. Is there anything you'd like to change?
4. Read over your writing again and consider the details you include. Remember how "telling" moves the action forward and "showing" moves slower but helps us experience the story. Make sure you are both showing and telling throughout your writing. (Pay attention to the sensory details you include as well!).
5. Consider the tone of your writing. Is it the tone you want?
6. Look for wordiness and delete unnecessary words.
7. Read your diary entry one more time and look for grammar or spelling errors to fix. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to assist you as well.

Turn in your revised description!

★ STUDENT/TEACHER TIP

Since the whole diary entry is in a 1st person perspective, the difference between showing or telling is also coming through the eyes of Eppie or Godfrey Cass. Here is an example of the difference between the two from a 1st person perspective:

Telling: "I wept."

Showing: "I felt moisture on my face and salt on my tongue."

• EXTRA HELPING

Consider adding illustrations to your work!

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WEEK 11 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 137

Punctuation and Usage

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE:

Use this time for finishing up writing assignments or adding to your commonplace book.

WEEK 11 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 138

Materials: Essay Voyage

→ PRACTICE

Use this time for finishing up writing assignments or adding to your commonplace book.

WEEK 11 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 35

→ DICTATE

Rotate through different books from your weekly readings to use for dictation.

WEEK 11 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 139

Essay - Character Sketch/Opinion

→ WRITE

What do you think makes a true hero according to Virgil? Do you agree with him?

OR

Write a character sketch of Aeneas or Silas Marner from Silas Marner. What is he like? What are his chief characteristics?

• REFERENCE

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 (Term 3)

Book: The Aeneid

General Literature: Grades 9-10 (Term 3)

Book: Silas Marner

WEEK 11 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 140

Questions

→ WRITE

Write as many questions about one or several of your books (or the connections between them) as you can during the time. Then circle the ones that you're particularly curious about.

WEEK 12 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 141

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer exam question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Essay Voyage

WEEK 12 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 142

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer exam question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Essay Voyage

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WEEK 12 20m Dictation: Grade 9 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS There are no exams for this course.	
WEEK 12 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 143 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	
WEEK 12 30m Grammar/Comp: Grade 9 - Lesson 144 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

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Examination

Term 1

Grammar/Comp: Grade 9

- Essay Voyage: Write an essay about what you have learned this term about writing an essay.
- Describe something you see outside from a 1st person point of view. Then describe the same thing from a 3rd person POV.

Term 2

Grammar/Comp: Grade 9

- Essay Voyage: Write several paragraphs talking about some of the important lessons of writing an essay you have learned this term.
- What is the difference between "showing" and "telling"? Give 5 examples.

Term 3

Grammar/Comp: Grade 9

- Essay Voyage: What ideas about writing have stood out to you the most as you have learned about the process of writing a formal essay?
- What is voice or tone in writing? Give a few examples of different tones in your readings. OR Describe the same experience in two different tones.